Steve Smith took the responsibility as captain and was banned, along with Warner and Bancroft, after sponsors and politicians weighed in, but there seemed more to it than that. That series against us had a strange emotional intensity. When Nathan Lyon, a genuinely nice guy, spoke about being prepared to ‘headbutt the line’, it wasn’t healthy.

Darren Lehmann, as coach, stood down in a tacit admission that the culture he had helped to create had soured. The Cape Town incident itself, in which TV pictures captured Bancroft hurriedly stuffing the yellow sandpaper down his pants, was comically inept. I suppose it shows what happens when you’re under pressure and don’t think clearly.

Our suspicions had been aroused in Perth, when they managed to get the ball reversing an inordinate amount when the outfield was still wet, following three hours’ rain. When the series was complete, and we had lost 4–0, the teams shared a beer in the dressing rooms at the SCG. Warner, a couple of beers into his celebration at the time, mentioned to a group of England players that he had used substances attached to the strapping on his hand to accelerate the deterioration of the ball during a first-class match.

I looked at Steve Smith, who shot a glance that said, ‘Ooh, you shouldn’t have said that,’ but I’m the type to let bygones be bygones. I felt for Smith when he was booed early in the 2019 tour of England, in which the Ashes was the main course after the World Cup hors d’oeuvre. He, and the other two, had accepted their punishment, served their time and deserved a clean slate.

Have there been times on the field when I’ve thought ‘you cheating bastards’? Of course, but you simply get on with the game. That’s how it is, how it was, and how it will probably always be in professional sport. People push the laws, and their luck, to the limit.